

Meoncross School History Department

**YEAR 8 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-
2027)**

Teacher Companion Guide

Curriculum Evaluation & Pedagogical Strengths

Strengths & Commendable Practices

Strong Local History Connections

Integrating local context into national and global events serves as a fantastic pedagogical hook. Mentions of the "Fareham ironmaster" in the Industrialisation unit and the profound impact of the "Lost Generation" on the "village of Stubbington" directly ground the history for our pupils. This makes the narrative tangible and relevant to their lived environment, fostering deeper engagement.

Thematic GCSE Preparation

The inclusion of *Water and Sanitation Through Time* acts as an excellent, low-stakes conceptual primer for the Edexcel GCSE *Medicine Through Time* thematic study. It introduces pupils to broad chronology (Roman to Industrial) and core concepts of change, continuity, and significance long before they hit the rigor of GCSE, ensuring a seamless transition.

Solid Chronological Foundation

By correctly sequencing the curriculum to transition from the broad sweep of *Water and Sanitation* directly into *Medieval England (1066-1485)*, pupils gain the vital contextual bedrock (feudalism, Church power, the monarchy) needed to understand the complex religious and power shifts of the Early Modern era.

De-centering the British Narrative

Starting with, or heavily featuring, the *History of Australia* and framing the Early Modern unit as *Global Encounters (1450-1750)* is a very modern, progressive approach. It intentionally moves away from the traditional, purely anglocentric Tudor/Stuart narrative to look critically at the mechanics of early empire, global trade, and the Transatlantic Slave Trade, creating a more diverse and inclusive curriculum.

Deep Dive on World War I

Splitting the Great War into two distinct units (Causes vs. The War) allows for rigorous historical debate (e.g., the Anglo-German naval race, alliance systems). This ensures

pupils aren't just learning the "mud and blood" narrative, but are actively grappling with complex geopolitical causation.

Points for Improvement for 2026/2027

1. Overweighting the 20th Century

Currently, there are two whole units dedicated to the Great War, plus units mapped out for the Second World War, the Shoah, the Cold War, and Post-War Britain. While vital, this risks creating a "modern-heavy" curriculum, sometimes at the expense of early world history.

2. Pre-1450 Global Diversity

The curriculum would benefit from a deep dive into non-European civilizations before European contact. Exploring the Islamic Golden Age, the Mali Empire, or the Silk Roads *before* looking at European "Global Encounters" in 1450 would give pupils a much more balanced view of global history, rather than encountering diverse cultures primarily through the lens of European colonization.

Evidence of Impact & Curriculum Mapping

1. Local Context & Coastal Connections

As a coastal school, our curriculum is intentionally designed to root global and national historical events in the maritime geography and lived environment of our pupils.

- **Oceanic Voyages & Penal Colonies:** The Year 8 Australia unit is deeply tied to maritime history, the brutality of ocean voyages, and the establishment of coastal settlements like Botany Bay.
- **Maritime Trade & Naval Dominance:** Our Early Modern World unit explicitly links global power to mastery of the oceans, naval exploration, and control of the Transatlantic Slave Trade.
- **The Anglo-German Naval Race:** The Year 8 Great War unit features a dedicated study on HMS *Dreadnought*, proving how a contest for control of the sea directly sparked global conflict.
- **Local Coastal Impact:** We explicitly study the "Fareham ironmaster" and the impact of the "Lost Generation" on the coastal village of Stubbington, bridging global events with local geography.

2. Historical Skills Progression

Our curriculum ensures rigorous, sequential development of disciplinary thinking from Year 7 through to Year 9, preparing pupils for GCSE demands.

- **Source Utility:** Moves from basic comprehension in Year 7 to evaluating provenance, motive, and audience (e.g., analyzing WWI propaganda and recruitment posters) in Year 8.
- **Historical Interpretations:** Progresses from identifying differing views to critically evaluating opposing academic debates (e.g., assessing modern vs. traditional interpretations of the Magna Carta or the 'Lions led by Donkeys' WWI debate) using contextual knowledge.

- **Argumentation (PEEL):** Pupils progress from supported, structured paragraphs to independent, multi-causal essays evaluating 'significance' and 'change over time'.
- **Causation:** Transitions from identifying simple triggers to categorizing long-term vs. short-term causes (e.g., the complex alliance systems and naval race of 1914).

3. Diversity, Equity & Representation

We are committed to delivering a curriculum that de-centers traditional anglocentric narratives, elevating the voices of the marginalized and giving pupils a truly global perspective.

- **Indigenous Perspectives:** The History of Australia unit critically examines the impact of British settlement on Indigenous peoples, moving beyond the traditional 'discovery' narrative.
- **Enslaved Voices:** The Early Modern World unit focuses on the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade and actively highlights how enslaved Africans resisted.
- **The 'Ordinary' Voice:** The Industrialisation unit explores how ordinary working-class people, rather than just monarchs, fought for a voice and the expansion of democracy.
- **The Forgotten Armies:** The Great War unit deliberately questions how much of a 'World' war it was by uncovering the forgotten contributions of the Empire's troops.
- **Experiential Learning (Ypres Trip):** The upcoming Year 9 Battlefields Trip to Ypres provides an invaluable opportunity for pupils to walk the ground of the Great War, cementing their classroom learning with powerful lived experience.

4. Pedagogical Strengths (SEND & Accessibility)

The integrated use of the Meoncross School History Department app alongside printed A4 workbooks and textbooks is deliberately designed to provide maximum support for SEND pupils:

- **Cognitive Offloading:** The combination of guided workbooks directly matched to structured digital tasks significantly reduces working memory strain, allowing pupils to focus entirely on historical thinking.
- **Dual Coding & Scaffolding:** The app utilizes consistent visual layouts, dual-coded images for vocabulary, and highly structured scaffolding (like sentence starters and PEEL frameworks) to support pupils with dyslexia or processing needs.
- **Multimodal Engagement:** By seamlessly transitioning between interactive digital tasks and focused reading from printed textbooks, the curriculum caters to diverse

learning profiles while preventing screen fatigue.

5. Substantive Concept Mapping

In line with modern KS3 history pedagogy, we actively track and weave substantive concepts ("big ideas" like Empire, Religion, and Power) across different periods. Rather than teaching these as isolated definitions, pupils build complex mental schemas by encountering them in varied contexts—from the power of the Medieval Church, through to the ideological clashes of the Cold War.

6. "Worldbuilding" & Cultural Literacy

Before pupils can effectively tackle abstract disciplinary concepts (such as causation or source utility), they require a rich "picture of the past". Our curriculum deliberately immerses pupils in the sensory and lived experiences of historical periods—such as daily life in a medieval village or the harsh realities of a WW1 trench—ensuring a secure cultural and chronological grounding prior to high-level analysis.

KS3: Early Modern World & Global Encounters (1450–1750)

Year 8 | How 'global' was Britain's transformation between 1450 and 1750?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 Who held global power in 1450?	- Identify the major global powers and trading hubs in the year 1450. - Explain how the Ottoman Empire and West African kingdoms controlled global wealth. - Evaluate why Western Europe was on the periphery (edges) of world trade in 1450.	- Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Enquiry): What was the primary motivation for early global explorers? - Evaluating Primary Evidence
Lesson 2 How did religious conflict trigger global exploration (1517–1588)?	- Explain how the Protestant Reformation shattered European unity after 1517. - Analyze the role of Elizabethan privateers in challenging Catholic Spain's global monopoly. - Evaluate how the Spanish Armada (1588) marked a turning point in Britain's imperial ambitions.	- Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Change & Continuity): How did the printing press revolutionize the spread of ideas? - Interrogating Historical Sources

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 Trade or takeover: How did early encounters turn into empire?	- Explain how joint-stock corporations (like the East India Company and Virginia Company) funded early English expansion. - Compare the early English colonial encounters in North America (Roanoke and Jamestown) with mercantile trade in Mughal India. - Evaluate the turning point where peaceful commercial trade shifted into territorial takeover and subjugation.	- Assessment: Formative Question (Causation): Identify three major causes of the Protestant Reformation. - Primary Source Analysis - Exam Practice Writing
Lesson 4 James I and the Gunpowder Plot: Why was religious division so volatile?	<i>Historical Enquiry</i>	- PEEL Paragraph (Significance): Newspaper Front Page - Working with Contemporary Accounts

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 5 Who controlled Britain? The Ideological Battle	- Analyze why Charles I and Parliament fought the English Civil War (1642–1651). - Evaluate how colonial wealth from sugar and tobacco reshaped British politics during the Commonwealth. - Debate who held true power in Britain by 1660: the Monarchy, Parliament, or Atlantic Capitalists.	- PEEL Paragraph (Causation): Lesson Reflection: Was the English Civil War a true revolution that gave power to the people, or just a transfer of power from the King to wealthy ... - Evaluating Primary Evidence
Lesson 6 Who controlled Britain? The Economic Shift	- Analyze why Charles I and Parliament fought the English Civil War (1642–1651). - Evaluate how colonial wealth from sugar and tobacco reshaped British politics during the Commonwealth. - Debate who held true power in Britain by 1660: the Monarchy, Parliament, or Atlantic Capitalists.	Interrogating Historical Sources

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 7 What were the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade?	• Understand the Triangular Trade and the middle passage. • Evaluate the economic legacy of slavery on Britain.	• PEEL Paragraph (Significance): UCL Research Task Worksheet: Summarize the core findings."I - Identify (make your point) D - Describe (give historical evidence/detail) E - Explain... • PEEL Paragraph (Significance): Lesson Reflection: How did the reality of the Transatlantic Slave Trade and the brutal 'death camp' model of the Caribbean sugar plantations challenge... • Primary Source Analysis
Lesson 8 How did enslaved Africans resist the Transatlantic Slave Trade?	• Understand the different forms of covert and overt resistance. • Analyze primary sources from formerly enslaved Africans. • Investigate the Jamaican Maroon Wars.	• PEEL Paragraph (Causation): Lesson Reflection: Why is it historically inaccurate and damaging to claim that the abolition of the slave trade was purely the result of benevolence... • Working with Contemporary Accounts • Analytical Essay

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 9 How 'modern' was Britain by 1750? (Synthesis & Assessment)	- Define what historians mean by a 'modern' state in the context of 18th-century Europe. - Synthesise domestic social realities with imperial/commercial expansion across the period 1450–1750. - Construct a high-level, structured final essay evaluating the extent of Britain's 'modernity' by 1750.	- Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Significance): What was the most significant change of the Early Modern era? - Evaluating Primary Evidence

KS3: Industrialisation, Empire, and Power (1750–1900)

Year 8 | Industrialisation, Empire, and Power: How did 19th-century Britain transform at home and abroad?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 What powered the Industrial Revolution, and how did a Fareham ironmaster change the world?	- Understand the difference between the domestic system and the factory system. - Explain the significance of Henry Cort's puddling and rolling processes. - Evaluate the importance of location versus innovation in Cort's success.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 2 Was industrial work progress or punishment?	- Understand the working conditions of the early Industrial Revolution with historical nuance. - Evaluate primary sources regarding child labour. - Analyse the 'Optimist vs. Pessimist' historical debate.	- Interrogating Historical Sources - Structured Paragraph

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 Did industrialisation make British towns unlivable?	- Analyse the contrast between imperial wealth and working-class squalor. - Evaluate the usefulness of contrasting primary sources. - Understand the catalysts for public health reform.	- Primary Source Analysis - Exam Practice Writing
Lesson 4 How was the British Empire built and sustained?	- Describe how the British Empire expanded through trade, military conquest, and colonisation across Asia and Africa - Explain how religious missions, economic exploitation, and resistance shaped the experience of empire for colonised peoples - Evaluate the significance of the British Empire in transforming global trade networks	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Synthesis Assessment (8 Marks): 'The British Empire was built and sustained by technological progress rather than violence and exploitation.' To wh... - Working with Contemporary Accounts - Analytical Essay

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 5 How did the Empire strike back? The 1857 Indian Rebellion	- Describe the causes and events of the Indian Rebellion of 1857 and the forms of resistance used by Indian soldiers - Explain how the rebellion challenged British imperial power and led to direct Crown rule over India - Evaluate the significance of the Indian Rebellion as an example of colonial resistance to empire	Evaluating Primary Evidence
Lesson 6 How did ordinary people fight for a voice?	- Describe the key protest movements of the 19th century, including Chartism and trade unionism - Explain how industrialisation created new forms of resistance and demands for democracy and parliamentary reform - Evaluate the significance of working-class protest in expanding the power of Parliament and moving towards democracy	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Synthesis Assessment (8 Marks): 'The violent machine-breaking of the Swing Riots posed a far greater threat to the British establishment than the p... - Interrogating Historical Sources - Structured Paragraph

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 7 How did the road to democracy expand?	- Describe the key reforms that expanded democracy in 19th-century Britain, including the Reform Acts - Explain how protest, resistance, and propaganda drove the gradual extension of the right to vote - Evaluate the significance of the suffrage movement in transforming British democracy by 1900	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Synthesis Assessment: To what extent was Britain a fully functioning democracy by the end of 1884? Use evidence from across the lesson to support y... - Primary Source Analysis - Exam Practice Writing
Lesson 8 Who truly benefited from 19th-century transformation?	- Synthesise knowledge of industrialisation, empire, trade, democracy, and resistance across the 19th century - Construct a sustained argument evaluating who truly benefited from Britains transformation - Deploy specific evidence about power, colonialism, and urbanisation to support a historical judgement	- PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Capstone Essay (16 Marks): 'The transformation of 19th-century Britain was a triumph of progress that benefited the entire nation.' To what extent ... - Analytical Essay

KS3: History of Australia

Year 8 | Invasion, Settlement, or Survival? How should we remember the colonization of Australia?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 Claiming Australia	• Describe how and why the British Empire claimed Australia, including Captain Cook's voyage and the concept of terra nullius • Explain the significance of colonisation for both the British Empire and the Indigenous Australian peoples • Evaluate whether the British arrival should be understood as discovery, settlement, or invasion	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 2 Creating a Convict Colony	• Describe the key features of the convict transportation system and explain why Britain used Australia as a penal colony • Explain how the British Empire used convict labour to establish a colonial foothold in the Pacific • Evaluate the human cost of the convict system and its role in the revolution of Australian settlement	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 Encounters with the Indigenous Peoples	• Describe the impact of British colonisation on Indigenous Australian communities, including the destruction of trade, culture, and land • Explain how Indigenous Australians showed resistance to British settlement through both armed conflict and cultural survival • Evaluate the significance of these encounters for understanding the long-term consequences of empire	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 4 From Penal Colony to Settlement	- Describe how Australia transitioned from a penal colony to a free settlement through migration and the Gold Rush - Explain how empire, revolution, and change shaped the development of Australian society in the 19th century - Evaluate who benefited most from Australia's transformation and who was marginalised	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 5 Lesson 5: Assessment - What's the story of Australia?	- Synthesise knowledge of colonisation, empire, resistance, and change across the history of Australia - Construct a sustained argument evaluating whose perspective should shape how we remember Australia's history - Deploy specific evidence to support a judgement about the legacy of empire in Australia	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Write a narrative account analyzing the development of Australia between the years 1788 and 1855. - Evaluating Primary Evidence

Key Vocabulary: Alsace-Lorraine, Ems Telegram, Reparations, Siege, Imperialism, Scramble for Africa, Empire, Colony, Dreadnought, Arms Race, Two-Power Standard, Naval Supremacy, Triple Entente, Triple Alliance, Reinsurance Treaty, Encirclement, Assassination, Black Hand, Ultimatum, Mobilisation